

Capturing the Document Understanding project requirements

This is a guide for Automation Developers and the other Automation Center of Excellence roles to help them collect and structure the document understanding automation project requirements.

Although it was written with a clear delimitation between the Automation Implementation stages, practice shows that the way it goes in real-life scenarios is, in many situations, non-linear: it can start with very detailed discussions and may leave some important aspects about the overall process for later. Thus, we recommend using it as a general guide and to make sure that there are no important aspects unaddressed.

In the Business case and technical validation stage (up to 5 days)

1. Set-up calls for the following: (Recommendation is to have the Business Analyst and Solution Architect present with DU knowledge to start filling in the PDD/SDD. It is their responsibility, but it is understandable if they are not available from the beginning).

- A walk-through of the “as-is” process.
- A walk-through of the “to-be” process.

Note: The Walk-through of the to-be process is proposed by the BA + SA and approved by the project.

It is important to manage the expectations, because the process outcome is heavily dependent on the customer providing sufficient document samples (15/vendor minimum):

- What does the customer expect from the end-to-end solution?
- What does the customer expect from UiPath's Document Understanding product?
- What are the SLAs or timelines required for the process of documents?
- Set realistic expectations on deliverables and required effort.
- Have clear & measurable KPIs as success criteria.

If the client is new to RPA/DU set up a meeting to explain terminology

- Do they want to set up a CoE?
- This can help later as saying the “OCR has an error rate of 50%” is completely different from “The robot has an error rate of 50%”

In the Process analysis stage (up to 5 days)

1. For the **As-Is process**, answer these questions:

- How are the documents being processed currently?
- Where are the documents coming from?
- How is the extracted data used?

- How much time does it take to process one document?
- What is the error rate?
- Do they use any software?
- What's the accuracy rate?
- Do they do any type of preprocessing or classification before extracting the data?
- What are their main pain points?
- What are the manual touch points in their end-to-end solution?
- How many people are processing these documents now?
- What is the current average handling time to process a document?
- What made them choose to switch to UiPath Document Understanding now - was there a specific event?

2. Gather data about the **documents** and answer these questions:

- What data needs to be extracted?
- Are the same fields extracted from each document?
- Are any fields optional?
- Document types and expected volumes?
- What is the expected volume of digital + scanned + pre-digitized documents?
- What is the scanned document quality?
 - Can they provide scanned samples for all expected quality levels?
- Files vs documents: input files contain one or multiple documents?
 - Can an input file also contain different document types (eg: a receipt & ID card within a single file)?
- How many document types/templates/vendors/languages are we expecting?
- What is the distribution of senders that you receive documents from?
 - Is it uniform or does a subset cover a large portion? (Eg: 80% of documents come from 10 vendors)
- Focus on the large volumes? (Generally, you should, but it might differ from use case to use case)
- Focus on easiest to automate? (Generally, you should, but it might differ from use case to use case)
- How many documents are processed by the customer every year?

- On average, how many pages are per document?
- Is there handwritten text to be extracted?
- Is there a requirement to extract non-text information (Logos, check boxes, barcodes, etc)
- Is the customer willing to provide sufficient sample documents for all doc types/templates/vendors/layouts/languages they want automated?

3. Find out which **languages** are in scope:

- Which language(s) are in scope for automation?
- Volumes/proportions for each language?
- Are there any documents containing multiple languages at the same time?

4. Find out what kind **deployments** the client will have:

- Cloud or On-premises deployment?
- For on-premises: on-prem online or air-gapped?
- What Cloud Vendor do they prefer?
- If AI Center is deployed - single-node or multi-node installation?
- Attended or Unattended automation?
- How many instances of AI Center do they want/have? (QA/Dev/Prod or simply have one AI Center instance for all and use public endpoints?)